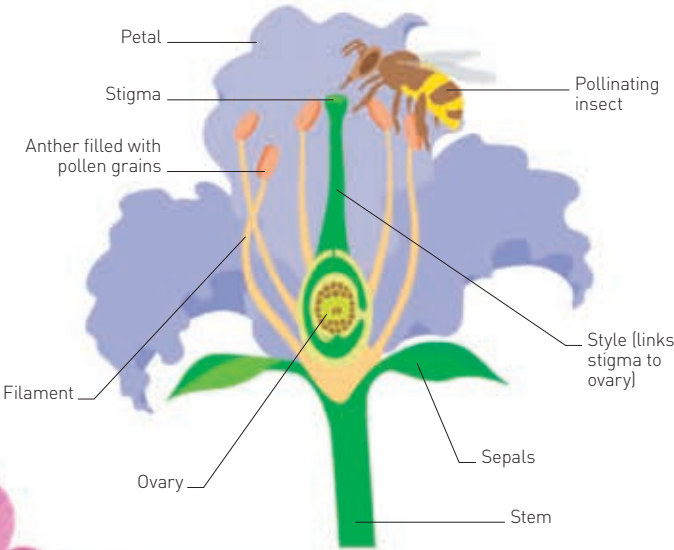


Flowers

Flowers, often colourful and scented, play a vital role in a plant's life cycle. They contain organs that produce pollen and seeds. Pollen is taken from one flower to another in various ways. The flower receiving the pollen is fertilized (pollinated) and then forms seeds to make new plants.

STRUCTURE OF A FLOWER

The parts of a flower are centred around the task of reproduction. Flower petals surround an ovary that produces eggs, and a stigma that is ready to accept pollen. When eggs and pollen meet, they create seeds.



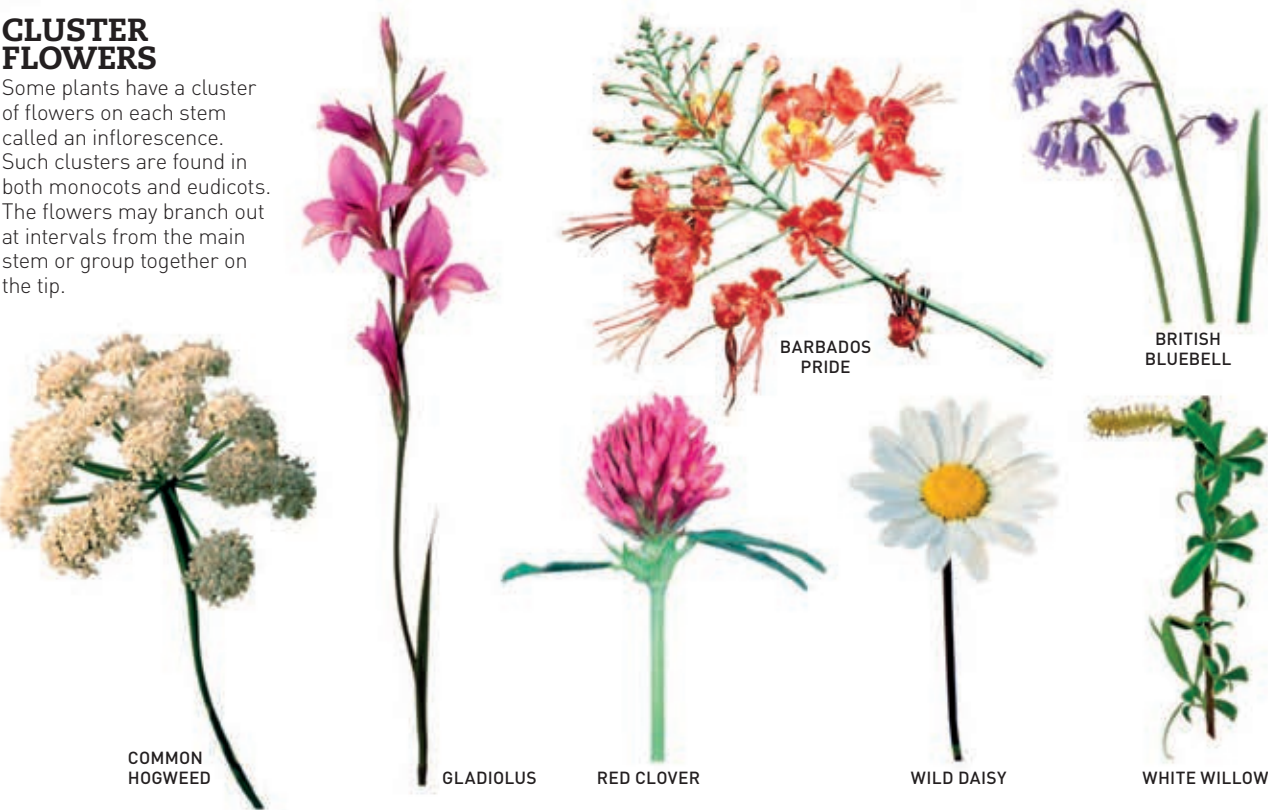
MONOCOTS

This group of flowers has several features in common: their petals are always in multiples of three; they have one main stem, which has very few leaves; and their stems contain veins that run in parallel lines.



CLUSTER FLOWERS

Some plants have a cluster of flowers on each stem called an inflorescence. Such clusters are found in both monocots and eudicots. The flowers may branch out at intervals from the main stem or group together on the tip.



GREEN FLOWERS

Plants with green flowers use wind pollination, as they are less attractive to insects. The flowers also tend to be small and not always easy to see. Their pollen-containing parts are positioned to catch the breeze.

